

# SOCIAL MEDIA AUDIT PROGRAM #42-80-00

The release of this audit program to parties external to IBM requires the written approval of the Chief Auditor.

This program is intended as a guide for assessing risk management in this process through the performance of an audit or a similar engagement. Risk management is the process to identify, manage, and control potential events in order to provide reasonable assurance related to the achievement of IBM's business and control objectives. IBM's control objectives fall into five broad categories:

1. compliance with external laws and regulations, as well as IBM policies and procedures
2. accomplishment of business objectives
3. reliable information for financial reporting and decision making
4. efficient operations, and
5. safeguarding both intellectual and physical assets.

The control assessment questions are intended to address process objectives from the categories above and the risks to achieving those objectives. Objectives and risks in the actual process under review may differ based on organizational, operational, regulatory, and economic factors. As such, individuals performing the engagement must formulate a test strategy based on risks relative to the actual process under review, regardless of whether the risks are identified within this program.

| DATE CHANGED   | SECTION # | SUBTITLE IN SECTION          | CHANGED BY (NAME) | COMMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------|-----------|------------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| September 2025 | Planning  | Audit Program Risk Alignment | CA&AS Ops         | Changes to audit risk levels from recent revalidation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| June 2025      |           |                              | Silvia Burt       | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Links in section PLANNING: Reference Material - <u>Social Media Related Guidelines</u> have been updated.</li> <li>2. Twitter updated to (X)</li> <li>3. Khoros – Access management tool has been replaced with Sprinklr. (also in IDR)</li> <li>4. Global Privacy Control Assessment (GPA) Questions replaced with Privacy Impact Assessment (PIA)</li> </ol>                                                                                                                                                                              |
| July 2024      |           |                              | Silvia Burt       | <p><b>No changes to audit program, however following changes have been applied to the audit process:</b></p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Update IDRs to ask whether teams are using <b>cross organization access</b>. Which scope areas are included in the specific audits? Instead of testing account only, we will test also the one who is posting. (access, content, etc.)</li> <li>2. ATL to <b>revalidate auditable units before every audit</b> (due to constant change in organization)</li> </ol> <p>Create an <b>audit team social contract template</b></p> |

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| DATE CHANGED | SECTION #                       | SUBTITLE IN SECTION | CHANGED BY (NAME) | COMMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
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| May 2024     |                                 |                     | Silvia Burt       | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li><b>Reference Material</b> section was updated with correct links to IBM guidelines.</li> <li><b>Key Social Platform</b> section: <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>added TikTok, and_BiliBili (China) and its definition</li> <li>added comment about YouTube</li> </ol> </li> <li><b>Governance and Oversight:</b> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>question 4 and 5 were merged into one</li> <li>added question about the process to manage accounts in transition (from the issue in the Comms audit)</li> </ol> </li> <li><b>Access Management</b> - added question about the process that defines how to manage Cross organization access to social accounts (Sprinklr changed to Khoros)</li> <li><b>Content Management</b> - added questions: <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>about retweeting/sharing external content</li> <li>about retweeting/sharing external content by cross org access</li> <li>claims on social media</li> </ol> </li> <li><b>Legal and Regulatory Compliance</b> - added question about PI/SPI consent</li> <li><b>Data Privacy and Security</b> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>moved the consent question to legal and regulatory compliance section</li> <li>removed question #3 on GDPR as it is covered in the questions added by the privacy team</li> <li>reworded question 4</li> <li>added testing section with specific tests required for Processors and Controllers</li> </ol> </li> </ol> <p><b>Education</b> section has been removed and generic question has been added to governance and oversight.</p> |
| July 2023    | Reference Material              |                     | Silvia Burt       | Updated links; added TikTok and_BiliBili (China), and YouTube comment                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| July 2023    | Governance and Oversight        | IB001.P             | Silvia Burt       | Merged Question 4 and 5; added Question 13 (process to manage accounts in transition)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| July 2023    | Access Management               | IB002.P             | Silvia Burt       | Added Question 8 (defines how to manage cross organization access to social accounts; Sprinklr changed to Khoros)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| July 2023    | Content Management              | IB003.P             | Silvia Burt       | Added Question 7 (retweeting/sharing external content; Question 8 (retweeting/ sharing external content by cross org access); Question 9 (claims on social media)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| July 2023    | Legal and Regulatory Compliance | IB004.P             | Silvia Burt       | Added Questions 7 and 8 (PI/SPI consent)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

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| DATE CHANGED  | SECTION #                                                  | SUBTITLE IN SECTION | CHANGED BY (NAME) | COMMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| July 2023     | Data Security and Privacy                                  | IB005.P             | Silvia Burt       | Moved consent question to Legal and Regulatory Compliance; removed Question 3 (GDPR) – covered in questions added by privacy team; reworded Question 4; added_testing section with specific tests required for Processors and Controllers |
| July 2023     | Key Control Question: 1. Social Media for Official IBM Use | Education (IB006.P) | Silvia Burt       | Education section removed and generic question has been added to Governance and Oversight                                                                                                                                                 |
| April 2023    | Data Security and Privacy                                  | IB005.P             | Don Dobrzelewski  | Added Privacy Testing                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| February 2023 | All                                                        | All                 | CA&AS             | Converted from Notes into a Word document and into a Box folder                                                                                                                                                                           |

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# SOCIAL MEDIA

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### PROCESS AND OBJECTIVE

This is a comprehensive social media audit program suited for testing social media related risk areas at the corporate level (social discipline team) or at the account team level (brand, organization, business unit, or social ecosystem level). The corporate team manages the flagship IBM social media accounts. The remaining accounts used in IBM are grouped by ecosystems and are managed by local organizations or business units.

#### Process Definition

Social media has become an important tool for brand development and recognition, communicating product announcements, recruitment, and enhancing customer experiences. It is pervasive, ubiquitous, and has a transformative impact. Furthermore, it can provide speed and influence in transforming engagement and relationships with employees, customers, suppliers, and business partners.

#### Business Value

1. Social media is a vital component for communicating IBM's mission and demonstrating its leadership and broad capabilities in cognitive business, cloud, analytics, mobile, social, and security.
2. The development of IBM's image and brand.

#### Definition Summary

What is social media?

For consistency in defining social media and the risk behind its global reach and use, below is the context used when referring to social media:

- "It is the use of internet-based applications or broadcast capabilities to disseminate and/or collaborate on information" – [ISACA.org](https://www.isaca.org)
- The populist nature of social media makes it very useful for this purpose and conversely, can be very destructive if improperly used.
- It carries near anonymity and without the accountability in the sharing of information depending on the access or privilege to social media tools, such as:
  - Social networking – Facebook, X, (Twitter)
  - Professional networking – LinkedIn
  - Blogs – WordPress, Medium, Wix, Blogger, Blogspot, Drupal, Typepad
  - Content Aggregation and Sharing - Reddit, Tumblr, Pinterest
  - Image and video sharing – Instagram, Flickr, YouTube, Snapchat, TikTok
  - Social Messaging platforms - LINE, WeChat, WhatsApp
  - Additionally, there may be country specific platforms that are used in addition to the platforms listed above (e.g., Weibo for China)

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### PROCESS AND OBJECTIVE (Continued)

Note: there is a defined set of approved platforms that IBM uses. These can be found on the social discipline W3 page. IBM may or may not have branded accounts on the platforms listed above.

- It is used in various ways by the enterprise to:
  - Increase brand recognition and presence
  - Increase marketing and sales
  - Communicate the launch of new products and services
  - Personalize service to current and potential customers
  - Help resolve customer issues
  - Explore new advertising channels
  - Monitor competition
  - Capture talent for IBM

### Control Assessment Topics

This program consists of control assessment categories that are applicable to social media used for official IBM business.

- Section 1.1 – Governance and Oversight
- Section 1.2 – Access Management
- Section 1.3 – Content Management
- Section 1.4 – Legal and Regulatory Compliance
- Section 1.5 – Data Privacy and Security

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PLANNING: Audit Program Risk Alignment

### Social Media

| Defined Risk Area               | Audit Risk Level | Key Control Question              | Test Number |
|---------------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------|
| Access Management               | High             | Social Media for Official IBM Use | IB002.P     |
| Governance and Oversight        | Medium           | Social Media for Official IBM Use | IB001.P     |
| Content Management              | Medium           | Social Media for Official IBM Use | IB003.P     |
| Legal and Regulatory Compliance | Medium           | Social Media for Official IBM Use | IB004.P     |
| Data Security and Privacy       | Medium           | Social Media for Official IBM Use | IB005.P     |

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## PLANNING: Data Analysis

Data analysis should be a part of every engagement where data is available in databases or data warehouses that can be accessed through query programs. This concept enhances the risk-based auditing approach, makes the audit process more efficient, and increases the productivity of the audit team. When the audit team does not have the skills required to perform these tasks, assistance should be sought from the Technology team.

All data used for analysis must be reconciled to an independent source so that the auditor has confidence that the universe is complete.

The [Data Analysis engagement procedures in the Audit Manual](#) (link internal to CA&AS members only) provide further suggestions.

This table shows what data can be reviewed and analysis techniques.

| Data to be Analyzed               | Analysis to be Performed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Possible Anomalies                                                                                                             | Concern                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Universe of Social Media Accounts | This is a universe of all social media accounts that is produced by the social discipline team. It will include all official IBM accounts and unofficial social media accounts identified as related to IBM accounts based on defined criteria. (i.e., non-registered accounts posting official IBM information or accounts that are imitating IBM official communications) | Social media accounts could be established by anyone. Accounts could be providing false, incorrect, or misleading information. | IBM's image and reputation could be negatively impacted through unauthorized or inappropriate social media postings. |



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## PLANNING: Data Analysis (Continued)

| Data to be Analyzed                            | Analysis to be Performed                                                                                                                                                          | Possible Anomalies                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Concern                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Universe of Official IBM Social Media Accounts | Review listing of official IBM social media accounts to ensure account administrators are current and compliant with the social computing guidelines and social brand guidelines. | <p>Administrators may not have completed all required education and training to ensure social media postings are aligned with IBM's overall social media strategy.</p> <p>Administrators may no longer be working in the same area or may no longer be employed with IBM. If an administrator changes positions or leaves IBM, access should be removed, and account passwords changed immediately (when applicable based on social platform).</p> <p>Account teams may be using accounts for official use without vetting them with the corporate social discipline team.</p> | Without the proper awareness of social media related guidelines and social media risks, IBM's image and reputation could be negatively impacted through unauthorized or inappropriate social media postings. |

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### PLANNING: Reference Material

#### Social Media Related Guidelines

IBM Owned Social Media Guidelines – <https://w3.ibm.com/w3publisher/the-social-discipline/ibm-brand-channels/ibm-owned-social-media-guidelines>

IBM Cybersecurity Resources - <https://w3.ibm.com/cybersecurity/>

IBM Business Conduct Guidelines - <https://w3.ibm.com/w3publisher/trust-compliance/bcgs>

Social Discipline - <https://w3.ibm.com/w3publisher/the-social-discipline>

Content and IBM Internal Privacy Statement - <https://w3.ibm.com/w3publisher/w3-privacy-notice/>

Paid Social Guidelines - <https://w3.ibm.com/w3publisher/the-social-discipline/ibm-brand-channels/paid-social>

Social Governance and Compliance - <https://w3.ibm.com/w3publisher/the-social-discipline/ibm-brand-channels/social-compliance-and-governance>

#### Other Useful Corporate Instructions and Information

Information Technology Security Standard (ITSS) - <https://pages.github.ibm.com/ciso-psg/main/standards/itss.html>

DG 101: Data Governance - <https://w3.ibm.com/ibm/corporate-documents/cdo/dg101>

Protection of Employee Information - <https://w3.ibm.com/ibm/corporate-documents/hr/hr-guidelines>

IBM Corporate Security Manual - <https://w3.ibm.com/w3publisher/corporate-security/process-tools/security-manual>

IBM Corporate Security Website - <https://w3.ibm.com/w3publisher/corporate-security>

The Office of Privacy and Responsible Technology - <https://w3.ibm.com/ibm/privacy/>

IBM Privacy website - <https://w3.ibm.com/w3publisher/privacy-at-ibm>

Receipt and Disclosure of Confidential Information - <http://3.ibm.com/w3publisher/confidentiality-agreements-hub>

LEG 116: Classification and Control of IBM Information - <https://w3.ibm.com/ibm/corporate-documents/leg/leg-116>

LEG117: Internet Privacy - Personal Information Collected On-line - <https://w3.ibm.com/ibm/corporate-documents/leg/leg-117>

General Data Protection Regulation Information - <https://w3.ibm.com/ibm/privacy/gdpr>

#### Key Social Tools Used

Sprinklr - <https://w3.ibm.com/w3publisher/the-social-discipline/ibm-brand-channels/sprinklr>

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### PLANNING: Reference Material (Continued)

#### Key Social Platforms

- **X** – sees the highest volume of daily posts that include earned media coverage, IBM news, cultural content, photography, and innovations for our global audience. Most of our curation work occurs via X.
- **Facebook** – Focus on IBM's culture, globally relevant news and innovations from IBM's key areas, and our history. As Facebook supports a wide variety of media, content types range from curated photography, video, 360 video technology and live broadcasts.
- **LinkedIn** – Used to provide an inside look at IBM's working culture and business strategy through executive thought leadership and earned media coverage.
- **TikTok** - Is a short-form video hosting service that works like a social media platform. It hosts user-submitted videos, which can range in duration from 3 seconds to 10 minutes that can be shared and commented on by viewers.
- **YouTube** – IBM's platform for video distribution. YouTube is not considered a "social media" platform by the corporate social media team. However, YouTube accounts are now governed by the requirements defined in the IBM-Owned social media guidelines and should be tested as such.
- **Instagram** – Instagram is our platform for showcasing, visually, our brand's culture for design and innovation. Our story is told through beautiful, inspiring, and carefully curated photography.
- **Messaging apps** (Slack, LINE, WeChat, WhatsApp, Snapchat).
- **Country-Specific Platforms** – IBM has approved accounts for Weibo (China), WeChat (China), Bilibili (China)
- **Emerging Platforms where IBM is piloting** (Twitch)

\*Note: This listing is not exhaustive. Platforms are continuously changing, and new platforms are emerging. However, a listing of IBM approved platforms can be found on the social discipline w3 page.

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## PLANNING: Fraud Template

Fraud is any intentional act or omission designed to deceive others and resulting in the victim suffering a loss and/or the perpetrator achieving a gain. Fraud can be categorized into fraudulent financial reporting, misappropriation of assets, and improper or unauthorized expenditures.

Note: The probability and impact will vary depending on the organization/business unit that is being audited.

| Description of Fraud Risk                           | Typical Controls that should Detect the Fraud Risk                                                                                                                                                                                    | Testing Approach                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Unauthorized or inappropriate social media content. | Certification of account administrators and periodic monitoring of social media content.                                                                                                                                              | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Review process for reviewing and approving social content if applicable for that account.</li> <li>2. Ensure that all account administrators are on the social discipline mailing list, are a part of the "All Things Social" Slack Channel, and that they regularly visit the social discipline w3 website for new requirements, education, and tools.</li> <li>3. Ensure that users who have access to social media accounts: <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. are still employed with IBM and in a role associated with the social accounts, or</li> <li>2. are contracted to work on the social media account with an active IBM ID.</li> </ol> </li> </ol> |
| Unauthorized social media accounts.                 | Periodic review of social media accounts to ensure that they are authorized for official IBM use. These reviews should identify unauthorized accounts and work with the social media platform or account owners to have them removed. | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Review process for reviewing the inventory of social media accounts.</li> <li>2. Ensure any fake or unauthorized accounts are not posting official IBM information under these accounts.</li> <li>3. If accounts are found to be posting such information, verify the appropriate process was taken in a timely manner to remove the accounts.</li> </ol>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

## SOCIAL MEDIA AUDIT PROGRAM #42-80-00

### CONTROL ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

Key Control Question: 1. Social Media for Official IBM Use

**Objective:**

This section focuses on the official use of social media for IBM. It addresses the risks associated with official announcements and communications of official IBM social media accounts.

**Risk/Exposure:**

Without the proper awareness of social media related guidelines and social media risks, IBM's image and reputation could be negatively impacted through unauthorized or inappropriate social media postings.

Failure to regularly review user access and formally document access management procedures and requirements, could result in users who retain access to social media accounts which could result in unauthorized or malicious social media posts.

Lack of employee awareness of applicable social media guidelines could result in employees not being appropriately trained in the handling of social media and could negatively affect IBM social media strategies.

Inadequate governance in the managing of official IBM presence in social media platforms could lead to the misrepresentation of the IBM brand or IBM message.

# SOCIAL MEDIA

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### CONTROL ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

Key Control Question: 1. Social Media for Official IBM Use

Primary Test: Governance and Oversight (IB001.P)

#### **Objective:**

To determine if social strategies and policies support the social media needs of the enterprise. These policies should protect the brand image of IBM and promote the responsible use of social media.

#### **Approach:**

In the official use of social media, review the relevant and applicable social media policies and standards and verify if they are followed. The test should address the following:

1. Is there a policy or standard defining the appropriate use of social media for official IBM use?
2. Are social brand administrators following the approved IBM social brand guidelines or other applicable social guidelines?
3. Have account administrators completed all required enablement activities and education prior to becoming an account administrator?
4. Did all accounts the required follow the official social media account request and approval process defined in the IBM-Owned Social Media Guidelines? Were the accounts approved by the director of Social Media & Influence?
5. Are there procedures in handling social media issues (e.g., security, unauthorized postings, anonymity, etc.) that arise which requires a unified and positive response?
6. Was there a crisis management plan defined and maintained in the Social Data System (SDS)?
7. Are there plans detailing the escalation process for responding to more serious comments and issues that may require higher level involvement? (e.g., Diamond Team, Public Relations, Information Security, Legal, etc.)
8. Are there success metrics that show the efficiency in the use of the social media? (e.g., Impressions, engagement, amplification, applause, resonance rate, etc.) Are they achieving the business purpose envisioned?
9. Are there Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) for responsiveness and are they being met? (i.e., Are people asking questions on social media and are they being answered?)
  - a. Are the KPIs reviewed with management?
  - b. Are actions taken to address trends or issues identified?
10. Is there a social strategy or platform publishing strategy that has been defined?
  - a. Has that strategy been implemented and tracked?
11. Was a Management Self-Assessment of Control (MSAC) performed for the auditable unit? If there were issues identified, was there an appropriate action plan implemented with committed target dates for resolution?

## SOCIAL MEDIA AUDIT PROGRAM #42-80-00

### CONTROL ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

Key Control Question: 1. Social Media for Official IBM Use

Primary Test: Governance and Oversight (IB001.P)

(Continued)

12. Was there a process to identify and act on rogue, imposter, or fake IBM branded social media accounts? If so, was there action taken to resolve the identified issues in a timely manner?
13. Was there a process to manage accounts in transition? (i.e., accounts that awaiting funding or that are planning to be decommissioned should have appropriate controls to protect and secure the account until final decisions and actions are taken)
14. Is there appropriate education for all employees, third parties, and management based on skills that addresses how to use social to align with IBM's social strategy?

# SOCIAL MEDIA AUDIT PROGRAM #42-80-00

## CONTROL ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

Key Control Question: 1. Social Media for Official IBM Use

Primary Test: Access Management (IB002.P)

### **Objective:**

To determine if there are proper controls and procedures in place to manage access to IBM's official social media accounts and management tools (e.g., Sprinklr, Sprout, etc.).

### **Approach:**

Select a sample of users performing social media tasks and review controls in place for the authorized use of social media tools. The tests should address the following:

1. Was there a defined access management process to grant, modify, and delete access to the social media accounts and social media management tools?
2. Was Sprinklr (or another approved tool) appropriately used to manage account access? (i.e., access to is restricted and based on a business need. Also, the terms of service or terms of use for the tool was adhered to)
3. Was the access management process followed for new or departing social media administrators?
4. Was there an assessment performed to prevent separation of duties conflicts?
5. Was there a periodic review of user access to verify employment or continued business need?
  - a. Was access to IBM social media accounts timely removed when a business need for users who had social media account access?
6. Are shared passwords for social media accounts appropriately managed to ensure that accounts are secure (i.e., in Box or a Password Management tool)? Specifically, passwords should be changed if account administrators leave IBM or change positions where social account access is no longer needed. This is applicable for platforms that do not have internal access administration capabilities and passwords need to be shared.
7. Does the access management process include steps to manage non-IBM users of IBM social media accounts? (i.e., third-party marketing contractors, vendors, agencies, etc.)
8. Was there a process that defines how to manage cross organization access to social accounts and did that process follow the control items listed above?



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### CONTROL ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

Key Control Question: 1. Social Media for Official IBM Use

Primary Test: Content Management (IB003.P)

#### **Objective:**

To ensure that the publishing of content and communications is authorized and approved at the right level for information used to disseminate marketing, financial, and product updates. In some cases, a Legal approval may be necessary for certain messages to be posted on a social community. Content should be considered anything posted or published to social media platforms (i.e., tweets, videos, posts, etc.).

#### **Approach:**

Select a sample of content and communications, associated with the social accounts within the scope of the audit, published to social media during the audit period and test the following:

1. Was a content approval process in place and followed to ensure that social media content and communications were reviewed and approved.
  - a. Was the process reviewed and updated on a regular basis?
2. Were all communications that were released to social media during the audit period properly approved (where required by the defined process) by the right approver before the release date, as defined by the established process? (i.e., if content is required to be reviewed by a content team)
3. Are there procedures to monitor and control for the inappropriate use or postings of content, comments, etc.? (i.e., of malicious, false, unauthorized, negative, out-of-policy, or misleading content published to social media)?
4. Was there a management system in place to report and communicate issues, risks, and deviations?
5. Are policies followed for the consistent use of company logos, images, pictures, etc.?
6. If third parties are used for content, is there a process in place to ensure the third party was acting according to the terms and conditions of the contract or agreement? For agreements in place during the audit period, was content in line with IBM's policies and the agreements with third parties?
7. Is there a process to manage retweeting or sharing external content on IBM social media platforms?  
What reviews and approvals are required?
8. Is there a process to manage retweeting or sharing internal content by cross organizational users?  
(Content posted by users in a different organization other than the one that owns the social media account.) What reviews and approvals are required?
9. Was the process for posting a claim to social media followed per the Legal Marketing requirements?  
(i.e., Claim coordinator review and Legal approval)

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### CONTROL ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

Key Control Question: 1. Social Media for Official IBM Use

Primary Test: Legal and Regulatory Compliance (IB004.P)

**Note: This listing is not exhaustive, and some may not apply to the accounts or team that is being audited. Additionally, there may be other laws and regulations specific to certain countries. The legal team should be contacted if there are general questions or to determine if there are country specific restrictions.**

#### **Objective:**

To determine if the use and management of social media complies with applicable legal and regulatory rules. Things to consider for this test in the official and employee use of social media tools:

- Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) allows companies to use social media networking sites to disclose material information; however, these disclosures must be distributed to the general public in a way that is “broad and nonexclusive.”
- Federal Trade Commission (FTC) Dot Com Disclosure Guidelines requires clear and conspicuous disclosures to avoid deceptions. It requires the connection between an advertiser and an endorser to be disclosed when the relationship is not apparent within the communication containing the endorsement. For example, if an advertiser gives a gift to a blogger or writer for posting content, it could constitute a material connection that is not reasonably evident to readers and should be disclosed.
- Australian Competition and Consumer Commission. Similar to the U.S. FTC guidelines, Australia has similar regulations that focus on misleading claims on social media or allow others to make misleading claims or comments. Proper policies must be in place that include monitoring and timely responses to false, misleading, or deceptive comments instead of removing them. There are several factors in consideration, such as size of organization, number of followers, and operation.

#### **Approach:**

Review the relevant and applicable social media policies and standards and verify if followed. The test should address the following:

1. Was there a process in place to ensure that all posted official communications comply with key local regulations and guidelines?
2. Was there a process to monitor adherence to regulatory and compliance rules affecting the use of social media?
3. Were the regulatory requirements included as part of the training of users of social media?
4. For any contests/sweepstakes/giveaway promotions run by the account teams, were the terms and conditions reviewed with the social discipline team and/or legal team?
5. Are there monitoring activities being performed by IBM that violate employee rights regulations?

## SOCIAL MEDIA AUDIT PROGRAM #42-80-00

### CONTROL ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

Key Control Question: 1. Social Media for Official IBM Use

Primary Test: Legal and Regulatory Compliance (IB004.P)

(Continued)

6. Has IBM Legal and Human Resources been involved in reviewing and approving any local policies and guidelines with respect to social media?
7. For IBM Employee PI/SPI posted to social media, was an IBM Employee – Photo and Video Consent form signed by the IBM Employee? For PI/SPI of IBM employees that are located outside the U.S., were local Legal teams contacted to review and approve?
8. Was there a valid IBM Social Consent form signed by IBMer that his/her PI/SPI can be published on Social Media accounts?

# SOCIAL MEDIA

## AUDIT PROGRAM #42-80-00

### CONTROL ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

Key Control Question: 1. Social Media for Official IBM Use

Primary Test: Data Security and Privacy (IB005.P)

#### **Objective:**

This section focuses on tests that will cover the official use of social media by IBM.

#### **Approach:**

Review the relevant and applicable privacy policies and applicable laws to determine if data is protected

and privacy ensured for all IBM customers and employees. The test should address the following:

1. If data is collected or disseminated which contains personal information, (this includes business personal information, sensitive personal information, etc.), is that data properly protected in compliance with IBM privacy policy?
2. Is there a control in place to ensure that IBM Confidential information is not posted to social media sites in accordance with Legal 116?
3. Was a global privacy assessment completed and approved for any tools that are used to support social media? If there are any open action items, are there action plans with committed target dates?

#### **Test: Privacy**

##### **Objective:**

Privacy laws impose requirements on how IBM and its Clients process Personal Information (PI). The Global Privacy Control Assessment Questions or Privacy Impact Assessment (PIA) questions are composed with two key areas of the business to help address compliance with these various high-level laws.

**IBM as a Controller** – The Enterprise Privacy Baseline – Controller establishes the high-level requirements that IBM must meet when acting as a Controller of Personal Information (PI). That is, PI that IBM collects and processes for its own purposes, such as Business Contact Information that IBM holds on its existing or potential customers or suppliers.

**IBM as a Processor** – The Enterprise Privacy Baseline – Processor establishes the principles and requirements that IBM must meet when acting as a Processor of Client Personal Information (PI) and applies to all products, offerings, and services (including their components) that IBM provides to Clients, regardless of whether IBM develops or re-brands them, or provides them for a fee or on a beta, trial, or no-charge basis.

##### **Approach:**

Review the Data Privacy responses provided from the Initial Data Request. Determine if IBM is Controller or Processor of PI/SPI data in the process.

# SOCIAL MEDIA

## AUDIT PROGRAM #42-80-00

### CONTROL ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

Key Control Question: 1. Social Media for Official IBM Use

Primary Test: Data Security and Privacy (IB005.P)

(Continued)

Testing:

IBM as Controller:

If IBM is Controller, request a risk-based sample of Global Privacy Assessments or Privacy Impact Assessment (PIA) for the processes and/or assets. Complete the testing from the following link:

<https://ibm.ent.box.com/folder/204812837247?s=75253udkcr7jop7vs7vo3q571ya60pkp>

IBM as Processor

If IBM is Processor, select a sample of products/offerings/services provided for the in-scope activities. Complete the testing from the following link:

<https://ibm.ent.box.com/folder/204814834141?s=r7zvz7ddipn4ri5y91mvjym3040z71i>

IBM as both Controller and Processor

Test either IBM as Controller or Processor, do not test both. Consider the volume and sensitivity of the controller and processor data and select the higher risk.